



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	Entry: 7/22/26 At 1:13 pm suspicious file was downloaded
Description	An employee received an email containing a file attachment. The employee downloaded the file and opened it. Multiple files execute without authorization and an intrusion is detected in the system. An alert is set out to SOC.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? An employee who fell victim to a phishing email. • What happened? The employee downloaded the malicious attach file, which ran unauthorized executables. • When did the incident occur? The incident occurred at 1:13 PM. • Where did the incident happen?

	The attack originated via email and impacted the employee's workstation. • Why did the incident happen? The reason why this incident happened is because the employee did not check the email address and verify that this was not a malicious email.
Additional notes	N/A

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	Entry: 7/22/26 Ticket and playbook handling
Description	An employee received an email containing a file attachment. The employee downloaded the file and opened it. Reviewing the email and SOC level 1 playbook
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal Practice ticket in a google doc
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? An employee who fell victim to a phishing email. • What happened? The employee downloaded the malicious attach file, which ran unauthorized executables. • When did the incident occur? The incident occurred at 1:13 PM. • Where did the incident happen?

	The attack originated via email and impacted the employee's workstation. • Why did the incident happen? The reason why this incident happened is because the employee did not check the email address and verify that this was not a malicious email.
Additional notes	I searched in the playbook for what to do for phishing attacks and I decided since it was a medium level severity to elevate it to SOC level 2 like the playbook says to do.

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	Entry: 7/23/26 Analyzing packet
Description	We looked at the frame, connection protocol, Internet Protocol, and Transmission Control Protocol. To see if everything was captured, what was the source and destination, what IP address the source and destination had, and which port they were doing it from.
Tool(s) used	Wire shark
Additional notes	We searched up packets using searches like ip.addr == <ip address>. To see what packets were being sent to and from that IP address. Some more exp.: • Ip.src - Anything that has the source ip (sender ip) • Ip.dst - Anything that has the destination IP (Recipient ip) • Eth.addr - Looks for anything that has the same MAC address

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	Entry: 7/24/26 Performing queries with Wazuh to search training data.
Description	Using a Wazuh VM I was able to use a yaml file to ingest log data. Search through index data evaluating the results and identifying different data sources.
Tool(s) used	SIEM: Wazuh Configuration: Shared folder auto-mount, YAML ingestion rules
What I did	Well I started with gaining the sample data and sharing the folder from my computer to the VM. Making it so it auto mounts and double checking the permissions with root. After the confirmation I went over to the IP address and connected to the main dashboard using HTTPS. Searched all across the index with searches like buttercup-games* and host.keyword: mailsv AND (fail* OR failed) AND root
Additional notes	n/a

Reflections/Notes:

7/22/26 – Phishing Incident Response

In this entry, I demonstrated a solid grasp of initial incident response and root-cause analysis following a successful social engineering attack. By systematically breaking down the event using the 5 W's framework and referencing VirusTotal, clearly mapping out the attack lifecycle from the moment a user opened a malicious phishing attachment to the unauthorized execution of files and the triggering of a SOC alert.

7/22/26 – Ticket & Playbook Handling

In this entry, I demonstrated how structured workflows and standardized procedures guide real-world security triage during a phishing incident. By combining the 5 W's investigative framework with a practice ticketing system and VirusTotal, you successfully analyzed how a user's failure to verify an email address led to unauthorized file execution on their workstation. Most importantly, I referenced the SOC Level 1 playbook to evaluate the threat level and correctly determined that a medium-severity incident required escalation to SOC Level 2.

7/23/26 – Network Traffic Analysis

This entry showcases my growing technical competence in lower-level network forensics using Wireshark to inspect raw frame and packet data across multiple protocols. By analyzing Ethernet, IP, and TCP layers, you gained practical experience pinpointing source and destination details, including IP addresses, ports, and MAC addresses. Additionally, my notes on syntax filters like `ip.src`, `ip.dst`, and `eth.addr` demonstrate that you are actively learning how to isolate specific network streams to trace threat actor activity across both Layer 2 and Layer 3.

7/24/26 – SIEM Log Ingestion & Querying

My final entry highlights practical engineering and threat-hunting skills within a Wazuh SIEM environment, bridging administration with security monitoring. I successfully managed end-to-end log flow by setting up shared folders between host and VM, verifying root permissions, configuring YAML ingestion rules, and accessing the web dashboard over HTTPS. Furthermore, constructing targeted Lucene queries such as hunting for failed root login attempts on mail servers.